MIL-P-14591D(MR)
1 December 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-P-14591C(MR)
14 December 1970

# MILITARY SPECIFICATION

## PLASTIC FILM: NON-RIGID, TRANSPARENT

This specification is approved for use by the Army Materials and Mechanics Research Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of plastic film for use as windows, in fabric tops, and in duck and fabric covers of Military vehicles and similar applications.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

- CCC-C-419 - Cloth, Duck, Cotton, Unbleached, Plied-Yarns, Army and Numbered
- MMM-A-260 - Adhesive, Water-Resistant, (for Sealing Waterproofed Paper).
- PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wire Bound.
- PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood Cleated-Plywood.
- PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock Corner.
- PPP-B-1055 - Barrier Material, Waterproofed, Flexible.
- PPP-D-723 - Drum, Fiber.
- PPP-T-76 - Tape, Packaging Paper (For Carton Sealing).

MILITARY

- MIL-P-116 - Preservation-Packaging, Methods of

STANDARDS

MILITARY

- MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
- MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

FSC 9330

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Army Materials and Mechanics Research Center, Watertown, MA 02172 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

D 568 - Flammability of Flexible Plastics.
D 570 - Water Absorption of Plastics.
D 618 - Conditioning Plastics and Electrical Insulating Materials for Testing.
D 746 - Brittleness Temperature of Plastics and Elastomers by Impact.
D 882 - Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting.
D 1003 - Haze and Luminous Transmittance of Transparent Plastics.
D 1499 - Operating Light and Water Exposure Apparatus (Carbon-Arc Type) for Exposure of Plastics.
D 2240 - Indentation Hardness of Rubber and Plastics by Means of a Durometer.
G 23 - Operating Light and Water Exposure Apparatus (Carbon-Arc Type) for Exposure of Nonmetallic Materials.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic, Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification Rules

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Il 60606)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Unless otherwise specified, the supplier may select the type, class or grade of material to be used in producing the film. The supplier shall report to the procuring activity the trade name and manufacturer's number.



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3.2 Property values. Specimens prepared as specified in 4.3.1, shall conform to the property values specified in table I when tested as specified in the applicable procedure of 4.3.

Table I. Average property values for film[1/]

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Tensile strength, MPa (psi), min. | 137.8 (20,000) |
| Elongation at break, percent, min. | 90 |
| Total transmittance, percent, min. | 80 |
| Haze, percent, max. | 8 |
| Water absorption, percent, max. | 1 |
| Hardness range, durometer A scale | 76 to 96 inclusive |

1/ MPa = megapascal.

3.3 Flame resistance. When tested as specified in the applicable procedure of 4.3, the film shall stop burning in 5 seconds or less.

3.4 Heat degradation and dimensional stability. When tested as specified in the applicable procedure of 4.3, the film shall show no visible evidence of degradation and undergo a maximum of 2 percent linear dimensional change. Discoloring shall be considered visible evidence of degradation.

3.5 Sewability. When tested as specified in the applicable procedure of 4.3, the film shall withstand a minimum force of 38.6 kg (85 pounds) before failure. Failure shall constitute complete rupture of the film.

3.6 Low temperature brittleness. The film shall withstand the impact load specified without failure at -55° ± 2°C (-67° ± 3.6°F) when tested as specified in 4.3.11.

3.7 Resistance to fogging and clouding. When tested as specified in the applicable procedure of 4.3, the film shall show no evidence of fogging or clouding.

3.8 Subsequent total light transmission. Subsequent to testing as specified in 3.4, the remaining specimen shall show at least 90 percent of the original value specified in table I, for total transmittance. Also, after testing as specified in 3.7, a specimen shall show at least 90 percent of the original value specified in table I for total transmittance.



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3.9 Form. The film shall be furnished in the form of rolls or sheets as specified by the procuring activity (see 6.2).

3.10 Dimensions and tolerances.

3.10.1 Length and width. The length and width of the film or rolls shall be as specified by the procuring activity (see 6.2).

3.10.2 Thickness. The thickness of the film and tolerance shall be as specified by the procuring activity (see 6.2).

3.10.3 Tolerances. The allowable tolerances on any dimension, except thickness, shall be plus or minus 0.79 mm (1/32 inch) for film not exceeding 508 mm (20 inches) in length or width and for rolls not exceeding 508 mm (20 inches) in width. For film exceeding 508 mm (20 inches) in length or width, and roll width exceeding 508 mm (20 inches), tolerances shall be minus 3.18 mm (1/8), plus 6.34 mm (1/4 inch). For roll length, tolerances shall be minus 1 percent, plus 5 percent from length specified.

3.11 Workmanship. The film shall be clear and free from bubbles, waviness and scratches. It shall be polished on both sides and free from any yellowish color, dirt, grit, or other foreign matter that may affect appearance or serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated. For purposes of sampling, an inspection lot for examination and tests shall consist of all materials of the same type and same nominal thickness, made from the same material under fixed manufacturing conditions and submitted for inspection at one time.



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4.2.1 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of this specification and, to the extent specified, of all referenced subsidiary specifications. In the event of conflict, this specification shall govern.

4.2.2 Inspection of film.

4.2.2.1 Examination of film. Examination of the film shall be made in accordance with the classification of defects, inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) specified herein. The lot size, for purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105, shall be expressed in units of packages of film or rolls of film, as applicable for examination in 4.2.2.1.1, 4.2.2.1.2, 4.2.2.1.3 and in units of shipping containers for examination in 4.2.2.1.4.

4.2.2.1.1 Examination of film for defects in appearance and workmanship. The sample unit for this examination specified in table II, shall be one sheet or three yards if film is supplied in roll form as applicable.

Table II. Examination for defects in appearance and workmanship

| Examine | Defect |
|---|---|
| Appearance | Any cracks, holes, creases, scratches, blisters or scars. |
| | Nonuniform transparency, finish or texture. |
| | Surface not smooth. |
| | Presence of dirt, foreign material, imbedded particles. |
| Workmanship | When applicable, sheets not flat. Edges not straight, square and smooth. |



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4.2.2.1.2 Examination of film for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination specified in table III, shall be one sheet or 1 roll as applicable.

Table III. Examinations for dimensional defects

| Examine | Defect |
|---|---|
| Length and width of film width of rolls | Film 510 mm (20 inches) or less in length or width vary by more than plus or minus 0.79 mm (1/32 inch) from that specified. Film over 510 mm (20 inches) in length or width vary by more than minus 3.18 mm (1/8 inch) plus 6.34 mm (1/4 inch) from that specified.<br><br>Rolls 510 mm (20 inches) or less in width vary by more than plus or minus 0.79 mm (1/32 inch) from that specified. Rolls over 510 mm (20 inches) in width vary by more than minus 3.18 mm (1/8 inch), plus 6.34 mm (1/4 inch) from that specified.<br><br>Length of rolls varies by more than minus 1 percent, plus 5 percent from that specified or required by contract. |
| Thickness | Unless otherwise specified, varies by more than the following tolerances.<br><br>Film thickness, mm (inches) ± percent tolerance<br><br>Up to 0.254 mm (0.010 inch) 20<br>0.254 to 0.508 mm (0.010 up to 0.020 inch) 15<br>Over 0.508 mm (0.020 inch) 10 |

4.2.2.1.3 Examination of film for average count per package or average length per roll as applicable. The sample unit for this examination shall be one package of film or one roll as applicable. Not less than three packages of film or three rolls shall be counted or measured. The average count per package or length per roll shall not be less than that specified or required by contract.



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4.2.2.1.4 Examination of packaging. An examination shall be made in accordance with table IV to determine that the preservation, packing, count and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operations. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for closure defects.

Table IV. Examination of packaging

| Examine | Defect |
|---|---|
| Preservation | Not level specified, not as required by contract. |
| | Sheets not interleaved. |
| | Rolls not evenly wound on core; not restrained; outside diameter of core less than 3 inches. |
| | Rolls exceed 241 mm (9-1/2 inches) in diameter of 29.5 kg (65 pounds) in weight. |
| Packing | Not level specified, not as required by contract. |
| | Closure not made by specified methods or materials. |
| | Any nonconforming component, component missing, damaged or otherwise defective affecting serviceability. |
| Count | Less than the specified or indicated number of packages of sheets or number or rolls as applicable. |
| Weight | Gross weight exceeds specified requirements. |
| Markings | Interior or exterior markings (as applicable) omitted, illegible, incorrect, of improper size, location or sequence or method of application. Not in accordance with contract requirements. |



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4.2.2.1.5 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) for examination. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) expressed in defects per 100 units shall be as follows:

| Examination paragraph | Inspection level | AQL |
|---|---|---|
| 4.2.2.1.1 | II | 1.5 |
| 4.2.2.1.2 | S-4 | 4.0 |
| 4.2.2.1.3 | S-4 | - |
| 4.2.2.1.4 | S-4 | 4.0 |

4.2.3 Classification of tests. All tests shall be classified as follows:

a. Lot acceptance tests (see 4.2.3.1).
b. Periodic lot check tests (see 4.2.3.2).

4.2.3.1 Lot acceptance testing. Lot acceptance testing shall be conducted in accordance with table V for the characteristics as indicated therein on each lot submitted for acceptance. The sample unit shall be one piece of sheet having two square feet area with 305 mm (12 inches) minimum dimensions. Three sample units shall be randomly selected throughout the lot. There shall be no failure of the unit or average result to meet the minimum requirements for the applicable property.

Table V. Lot acceptance testing

| Property | Number of specimens or determinations |
|---|---|
| Tensile strength | 3 1/ |
| Elongation | 3 1/ |
| Total transmittance | 3 |
| Haze | 3 |
| Hardness | 3 |
| Flame resistance | 3 |

1/ Test report shall include all values on which average values are based. If material is anisotropic, three tests parallel and three tests normal to the principal axis of anisotropy shall be conducted.



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4.2.3.2 Periodic lot check testing. Periodic lot check tests shall consist of all tests specified in 4.3 excluding the tests listed in table V. Periodic lot check tests shall be made on the first lot of film furnished under this specification and on any subsequent lot specified by the procuring activity (see 6.2). When periodic lot check testing is required, the sample unit size and numbers of sample units shall be as specified in 4.2.3.1 for lot acceptance testing. There shall be no failure of the unit or average result to meet the minimum requirement for the applicable property. When periodic lot check tests are made, they shall be included in the basis for acceptance or rejection of the lot.

4.2.4 Testing. The film shall be tested for the applicable characteristics listed in table V, and specified in 4.2.3.2 (when periodic lot check tests are required), in accordance with the test methods specified herein. The lot size for purposes of sample size for testing (see MIL-STD-105) shall be expressed in units of 45.4 kg (100 pounds) of film. The sample unit shall consist of sufficient material to prepare all required specimens. The inspection level shall be S-1, with an acceptance number of 0. The results of each test shall be the averaged results of the specimens, except where only one determination is required.

4.3 Test methods.

4.3.1 Specimen preparation. Test specimens shall be obtained from the sample unit (see 4.2.4), and prepared in accordance with the applicable test method. Thickness of test specimens shall be that of the film furnished in the contract or purchase order.

4.3.2 Conditioning and testing. All specimens shall be conditioned in accordance with procedure A of ASTM D 618. Unless otherwise specified, all testing shall be done at 23° ± 2°C (73.4 ± 1.8°F) and 50 ± 5 percent relative humidity.

4.3.3 Tensile strength and elongation. Three specimens shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 882, using method A and the strain rate specified in this test method for the thickness supplied (see 4.3.1).

4.3.4 Total transmittance. Three specimens shall be tested in accordance with either procedure A or B of ASTM D 1003. The total transmittance value shall be multiplied by 100 to obtain percent total transmittance.

4.3.5 Haze. Three specimens shall be tested in accordance with either procedure A or B of ASTM D 1003.

4.3.6 Water absorption. One specimen shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 570.



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4.3.7 Hardness. Three specimens shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 2240, using the type A durometer.

4.3.8 Flame resistance. Ten specimens shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 568. Average time of burning shall be reported.

4.3.9 Heat degredation and dimensional stability. Five specimens each 254 ± 25.4 mm (10 ± 0.1 inch) by 254 ± 25.4 mm (10 ± 0.1 inch) shall be tested in the following manner: The dimensions for each specimen shall be measured three times in both the machine direction and the transverse direction at 23 ± 1°C (73.4 ± 1.8°F) before and after the heating period of the test. For the heating period, the specimens shall be suspended freely in an oven controlled to 82° ± 3°C (180° ± 5.4°F) for 30 ± 1 minutes. Measurements shall be made with a rule calibrated to 0.254 mm (0.01 inch). Shrinkage is obtained by dividing the change in length by the original length, and multiplying this ratio by 100. Shrinkage determinations on the five specimens shall be averaged for each direction.

4.3.10 Sewability. One specimen of the film shall be tested and shall be 76.2 ± 7.62 mm (3 ± 0.3 inches) wide by 152 ± 15.2 mm (6 ± 0.6 inches) long. Each end of the specimen shall be sewn between 2 layers of cotton duck using a number 23 needle, 10/4 thread, with a lock stitch, a maximum spacing of 5 stitches for each 25.4mm (inch), and one row of stitching. The cotton duck shall be the 8.25 ounce type III Army duck conforming to CCC-C-419 and shall be of convenient size for use in the testing machine. The two layers of cotton duck along each end of the film shall be clamped in the jaws of the testing machine. Testing shall be in accordance with ASTM D 882, using method A and the strain rate specified in this test method for the thickness supplied (see 4.3.1). The maximum load shall be recoorded.

4.3.11 Low temperature brittleness. Three specimens shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 746. Specimen dimensions shall be in accordance with ASTM D 746 and none shall fail.

4.3.12 Resistance to fogging and clouding. One specimen shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 1499 using the water spray specified in ASTM G 23. The light source shall consist of a vertical, ventilated flaming carbon using Sunshine carbon electrodes or equivalent (see 6.3) operated at 60 ± 1 amperes and 50 ± 1 volts across the arc. Filters shall be the Corex D type or equivalent (see 6.3) in transmission characteristics, and specimen dimensions shall be as specified in ASTM D 1499. The rack shall rotate at 0.5 ± 0.05 rotations per hour and total testing exposure time shall be 240 ± 1 hour. Specimens shall be examined after 48 and 144 hours and if fogging or clouding is revealed, the test shall be terminated.



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## 5. PACKAGING

Application. The requirements of section 5 apply only to purchase by or direct shipment to the Government.

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Rolls. Each roll shall be wound on a core with an outside diameter of not less than 76.2 mm (3 inches). The rolls shall not exceed 29.5 kg (65 pounds) in weight or 241 mm (9-1/2 inches) in diameter, and shall be restrained from unwinding. Each roll shall be wrapped overall with 27.2 kg (60 pounds) kraft paper conforming to PPP-B-1055. Wrap shall have a minimum 305 mm (12 inch) overlap of the circumference and a minimum 76.2 mm (3 inch) overlap on each end of the roll. A disk of the same material as the wrapper, 25.4 mm (1 inch) less than the diameter of the roll, shall be placed next to the end of the roll and the 76.2 mm (3 inch) overlaps folded over and sealed with adhesive conforming to MMM-A-260. A second disk of the same material and size shall be placed over each end and sealed with the same adhesive. The seam of the wrapper shall be sealed with the same adhesive.

5.1.1.2 Sheets. The sheets, in the quantities specified by the procuring activity, shall be interleaved with a neutral paper, then loosely rolled and secured so as not to unroll. Each roll of sheets shall be wrapped completely with kraft wrapping paper conforming to PPP-B-1055 and secured with tape conforming to PPP-T-76. The method of unit packing is method III of MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 Level B. Preservation shall be the same as for level A (see 5.1.1).

5.1.3 Commercial. Rolls and sheets shall be unit packed in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.1.4 Disposability (see 6.4).

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Rolls. Rolls unit packed as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed into nailed wood, wood-cleated plywood, and wirebound wood boxes respectively conforming to PPP-B-621, class 2, PPP-B-601 overseas type and PPP-B-585, class 3. Boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the box specification. Gross weight of the shipping container shall be as specified in the applicable container specification.



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5.2.1.2 Sheets. The sheets unit packed as specified in 5.1.1.2 shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1.1.

5.2.2 Level B. Rolls unit packed as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed into nailed wood, wood-cleated plywood, and wirebound wood boxes, respectively, conforming to PPP-B-621, class 1, PPP-B-601 domestic type, and PPP-B-585, class 1. Sheets unit packed as specified in 5.1.1.2 shall be packed into fiber drums conforming to PPP-D-723, type 1, grade D, class 1 or class 2. Gross weight of the shipping container shall be as specified in the applicable container specification.

5.2.3 Commercial. Rolls and sheet, unit packed as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carrier rules and regulations.

5.2.4 Disposability (see 6.4).

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract (see 6.2), interior unit packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4 General. Exterior containers (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2 and 5.2.3) shall be of a minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The plastic film is intended for use as windows in fabric tops, and in duck and fabric covers of military vehicles and similar applications.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Form required (see 3.9).
c. Length and width required (see 3.10.1).
d. Thickness required (see 3.10.2).
e. Periodic lot check tests, if required (see 4.2.3.2).
f. Selection of applicable degrees of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
g. Unit package quantities and exterior container (see 5.1).
h. Special marking, if required, for unit packs and exterior container (see 5.3)

6.3 Equipment for fogging and clouding testing. Sunshine carbon electrodes are furnished by Atlas Electric Devices Company. Carbon electrodes for different spectral distributions are available from the National Carbon Division of union Carbide Corporation. Corex D filters furnished by Atlas Electric Devices Company, 4114 North Ravenswood Avenue, Chicago, IL 60613.



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6.4 Disposability of packaging materials. Environmental pollution preventive measures are contained in the packaging material specifications indicated in section 2. Refer to these specifications for recommended disposability methods.

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Review activities:
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User activities:
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| 3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION | 4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)* |
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| | ☐ VENDOR |
| b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* | ☐ USER |
| | ☐ MANUFACTURER |
| | ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____ |

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

| 7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional | b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional |
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